PRACTITIONER PROTOCOL

Deep Tissue & Sports Massage

Times in [brackets] suit a 60-minute session. Check your state board rules.

SCREEN

Intake reviewed. No clot signs, fever, acute injury under 72 h, or recent surgery without clearance.

CHECK-IN

Ask about goals, training, problem areas, areas to avoid, medications and today's pain level.

PRE-SESSION

Explain the 1–10 scale and the policy limit. Ask about nut, oil and scent allergies.

SET UP FIRST ☐ Fresh linens & cover ☐ Table disinfected ☐ Room warm ☐ Oils in pumps ☐ Nut-free oil ☐ Bolsters ☐ Hands washed

#	STEP	TIME	HOW
1	**Intake & consent**	5 min	Review intake. Explain draping, pressure scale and right to stop.
2	**Privacy to undress**	3 min	Step out. Client undresses to comfort level and lies under the top sheet.
3	**Positioning**	2 min	Knock first. Prone or supine; bolster ankles or knees, adjust cradle.
4	**Warm tissue first**	8 min	Broad effleurage and petrissage over the region before deep work.
5	**Slow sink-in pressure**	30 min	Region by region, sink in slowly; wait for the tissue to give.
6	**Stay within tolerance**	ongoing	Check in often; stay at or under about 7/10 [policy].
7	**Endangerment sites**	ongoing	No deep pressure on front of neck, back of knee, armpit, groin.
8	**Finishing strokes**	3 min	Lighter effleurage to finish, then still hands. Session ends.
9	**Privacy to dress**	3 min	Step out. Invite the client to sit up slowly and take their time.
10	**Notes & water**	6 min	Offer water. Review soreness, ice or heat. SOAP notes; rebook.

ENDPOINT AND SAFETY

- Genitals and gluteal cleft always draped
- Tissue warm before deep work; slow in, slow out
- Glutes, inner thigh, abdomen only with consent
- Sharp, burning or radiating pain means stop

Blood thinners, bleeding disorders or osteoporosis: light to moderate pressure only, no deep work. Acute injury: avoid the area for 48 to 72 hours.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- Dizzy: sit slowly, or lie back with legs up. Water, rest.
- Skin reaction: remove the product, wash with mild soap, switch to nut-free.
- Bruising: note it, advise ice, lighter pressure next time.
- Sharp pain, numbness or tingling: stop and reposition. Avoid the area.
- Clot signs (one calf swollen, red, warm, sore): stop, refer urgently.
- Chest pain, trouble breathing or stroke signs: call 911 right away.

Always write an incident report and check in with the client within 24 to 48 hours.

RECORD FOR THIS SESSION

Length · focus	Pressure (1–10)	Oil or lotion used	Areas worked
Areas avoided	**Client response**	**Therapist notes**	**Next visit · initials**